the lies that support them. With the banks, our work forced their practices into the open and made a marked difference in their sense of public accountability. And so it has been with military bodies as far apart as Kenya and the Pentagon. These actors depend on covert operations to prosecute violent incursions: and we are the spanner in their works, fighting all the time to expose the lies, end the conspiracy, hold up human rights and save lives.

As an example of this I give you Iran. For some time now, neoconservative elements in Washington, along with their Israeli allies, have been keen to instigate a war with Iran. This is not a mysterious matter. It has been well documented and well sourced by Seymour Hersh and others. Given that many military conflicts begin as border disputes, we kept an eye on the traffic of information there, and noticed that the British and the US military were literally sailing very close to the wind in the Gulf of Persia. Iranian military captured some British navy personnel and an approach was made by the Iranian navy to US vessels in their waters. We saw this early and I contacted Eric Schmitt of the *New York Times* to draw his attention to how this matter was included in a document on the rules of engagement we had leaked. ‘In a section on crossing international borders,’ wrote Schmitt, in what turned out to be an important article for the *New York Times*, ‘the document said the permission of the American Defense Secretary was required before American forces could cross into or fly over Iranian or Syrian territory. Such actions, the document suggested, would probably also require the approval of President George W. Bush. But the document said there were cases in which such approval was not required: when American forces were in hot pursuit of former members of Saddam’s government or terrorists.’

The Iranian government then responded: ‘The US forces in Iraq have no right to chase any suspect into Iranian territory. Any entrance to the Iranian soil by any US military force to trail suspects would be against international laws and could be legally pursuable.’ It stressed that Iran would ‘give proper response to any move in this connection in order to defend its security and national sovereignty’. If you look at the next set of the ‘Rules of Engagement’ published after this exchange, you will see that the officials changed them to make this kind of dispute less likely. That’s an example of a little document contributing to a change in policy, a change that potentially makes a vast difference to an ongoing chain of events. I’m not